

MANDAR DEODHAR

pandemic and, going by Kantar Worldpanel's FMCG Pulse data, which captures the sales of 50 branded and non-branded categories, could touch Rs 20,000 by the end of 2025.

How are the brands themselves luring this new breed of consumer? By offering her better value, improved benefits, interesting presentation and surprising flavours, as Shuvadip Banerjee, the chief digital marketing officer of FMCG giant ITC Foods, discloses. And so ITC sells the humble *atta*, the wheat flour staple sold under its brand Aashirvaad, in various versions, be it gluten-free, fortified, multigrain or sugar release control, along with a premium offering—Select Atta. "The health portfolio of *atta* has seen 1.3X growth in the past 12 months," says Banerjee. ITC is also winning consumer trust with initiatives like the unique QR code on its packaging, which allows consumers to trace the farm from where the raw materials have been sourced. And the premiumisation is happening not only at the health end of the spectrum, but also at the indulgence end. Fabelle, ITC's luxury chocolate range launched in 2016, grew 40 per cent in the past year. "The same consumer may want both ends of the spectrum at different points of the day or week," says Banerjee. "But they want pure-play nutrition when in health mode and pure-play indulgence when treating themselves."

That is true for something as commonplace as water, too. Sparkling water is stealing a march over still mineral water. As Bisleri found more consumers demanding a fizzy, non-caloric beverage, it launched Himalayan Sparkling Water under its premium natural spring water brand, Vedica, during the festive season. "In terms of revenue expectations, our aim is to capture a 5 per cent share of the overall market with Vedica," says Jayanti Khan Chauhan, vice chairperson, Bisleri International.

"The easiest way to label premiumisation," says Shweta Jain, chief business officer, luxury, reserve & craft, India &